

GEOGRAPHY

INTRODUCTION

Geography is about determining the significance of “place” as it relates to the natural environment, the human environment, and interactions within and between them. To investigate geographic issues, students must analyse the influences and interrelationships that give a place its distinctive characteristics and thus its spatial importance. Geographic analysis also requires an investigation of the economic, environmental, social, and political perspectives that relate to an issue. The application of the concepts of geographic thinking, spatial skills, and the use of field studies are central to the geographic inquiry process and the learning of geography.

Strands

The Grade 11 and 12 geography courses each have five strands. In all of these courses, strand A, Geographic Inquiry and Skill Development, is followed by four content strands, which are organized thematically.

Citizenship Education

The expectations in the Grade 11 and 12 geography courses provide opportunities for students to explore a number of concepts connected to the citizenship education framework (see page 13).

The Concepts of Geographic Thinking

The four concepts of geographic thinking – spatial significance, patterns and trends, interrelationships, and geographic perspective – underpin thinking and learning in all geography courses in the Canadian and world studies program. At least one concept of geographic thinking is identified as the focus for each overall expectation in the content strands of these courses. The following chart describes each concept and provides sample questions related to it. These questions highlight opportunities for students to apply a specific concept in their studies. (See page 16 for a fuller discussion of the concepts of disciplinary thinking.)

Spatial Significance
This concept requires students to determine the importance of a place or region. They explore the connections that exist between the geographical location and physical characteristics of a site and analyse the unique relationships that exist in and between the natural and human environments in a particular place. Students come to understand that the significance of the same place may be different for humans, animals, and plants. Related Questions* – What does a population settlement map tell us about the preferred range of latitude for settlement in Canada? (CGC1P, B2.2) – How does the official plan for your community address urban sprawl? (CGC1D, E2.3) – How might the uniqueness of a destination make it more appealing to some and less appealing to others? (CGG3O, B1.2) – How does the location of a site influence the feasibility of different types of power generation there? (CGR4E, E3.4) – What are some of the challenges that communities in permafrost regions face in providing safe drinking water and disposing of waste? (CGR4M, E2.3)
Patterns and Trends
This concept requires students to recognize characteristics that are similar and that repeat themselves in a natural or human environment (patterns) and characteristics or traits that exhibit a consistent tendency in a particular setting over a period of time (trends). The characteristics may be spatial, social, economic, physical, or environmental. Students analyse connections between characteristics to determine patterns; they analyse connections between those characteristics over time to determine trends. Related Questions – What trends do you see in the use of alternative energy in Ontario? (CGC1P, A1.5) – What pattern or patterns do you see in the location of First Nations reserves across Canada? (CGC1D, D3.1) – What factors have led to population movement in the region? What specific locations have attracted migrants? Why? (CGD3M, E2.1) – In what ways has technological change amplified the impact of population growth on the natural environment? In what ways has it diminished it? (CGW4U, C2.2)

* These questions are drawn directly from the overview charts that precede the geography courses and from the sample questions that accompany many specific expectations. To highlight the continuity between the geography courses in Grade 11 and 12 and those in Grade 9, and to show possible development in the use of the concepts of geographic thinking over those grades, the chart includes some questions from the Grade 9 geography curriculum as well.

Interrelationships

This concept requires students to explore connections within and between natural and human environments. The interconnected parts of an environment or environments work together to form a system. Students must understand the relationships that exist within a system and then critically analyse the relationships between systems in order to determine the impact they have on one another.

Related Questions

- How does surrounding farmland support a community, and what stresses might the community place on the farmland? (CGC1P, E2.1)
- How might the breaking up of continental ice in Greenland and the Antarctic affect Canada's coastline? (CGC1D, B2.1)
- Why do we need to understand the earth's physical processes in order to predict their potential hazards? (CGF3M, Overview)
- How can international trade policies and corporate actions influence disparities within or between ecumenes? (CGU4M, D1.2)

Geographic Perspective

This concept requires students to consider the environmental, economic, political, and/or social implications of the issues, events, developments, and/or phenomena that they are analysing. In order to solve problems, make decisions or judgements, or formulate plans of action effectively, students need to develop their ability to examine issues from multiple perspectives.

Related Questions

- In what ways can cultural diversity enrich the life of a community? (CGC1P, D1.2)
- Does the financial benefit of extracting natural resources justify related social and/or environmental impacts? (CGC1D, A1.6)
- How might spatial technologies help governments assess the economic, environmental, infrastructural, and social risks of a potential disaster? Why is it important for governments to know and understand these risks? (CGT3O, D1.2)
- Why might some people believe that there is an ethical imperative to share the world's resources equitably? (CGW4C, Overview)
- Why might military and/or government satellite information be shared with or withheld from certain countries or military alliances? What are the implications of doing so? (CGO4M, D2.1)

The Geographic Inquiry Process

In each of the geography courses in the Canadian and world studies curriculum, strand A focuses explicitly on the geographic inquiry process, guiding students in their investigations of issues, events, developments, and/or various geographic phenomena. This process is *not* intended to be applied in a linear manner: students will use the applicable components of the process in the order most appropriate for them and for the task at hand. Although strand A covers all of the components of the inquiry process, it is important to note that students apply skills associated with the inquiry process throughout the content strands in each course. (See page 32 for a fuller discussion of the inquiry process in the Canadian and world studies program.)

The following chart identifies ways in which students may approach each of the components of the geographic inquiry process.

Formulate Questions
Students formulate questions: – to explore various events, developments, issues, and/or phenomena that are related to the overall expectations in order to identify the focus of their inquiry – to help them determine which key concept or concepts of geographic thinking are relevant to their inquiry – that reflect the selected concept(s) of geographic thinking – to develop criteria that they will use in evaluating data, evidence, and/or information; in making judgements, decisions, or predictions; in reaching conclusions; and/or in solving problems
Gather and Organize
Students: – collect relevant qualitative and quantitative data, evidence, and information from field studies^a and a variety of primary and secondary sources,^b including visuals^c and community resources^d – determine if their sources are credible, accurate, and reliable – identify the purpose and intent of each source – identify the points of view in the sources they have gathered – use a variety of methods to organize the data, evidence, and/or information they have gathered – record the sources of the data, evidence, and information they are using – decide whether they have collected enough data, evidence, and/or information for their inquiry

a. Field studies may include, but are not limited to, studies in local neighbourhoods, school grounds, and various sites that allow students to explore different land uses (e.g., recreational, commercial, industrial, and transportation uses).

b. Primary sources may include, but are not limited to, census data, land claims, letters, photographs, speeches, and works of art. Secondary sources may include, but are not limited to, documentaries and other films, news articles, reference books, and most websites.

c. Visuals may include, but are not limited to, satellite images, maps, globes, models, graphs, and diagrams.

d. Community resources may include, but are not limited to, local conservation areas, resources from community groups and associations, government resources, and local plans.

Interpret and Analyse
Students: – analyse data, evidence, and information, applying the relevant concepts of geographic thinking (see preceding chart) – use different types of graphic organizers to help them interpret and/or analyse their data, evidence, and information – identify the key points or ideas in each source – analyse graphs, charts, diagrams, and maps – construct graphs, charts, diagrams, and maps to help them analyse the issue, event, development, or phenomenon they are investigating – analyse their sources to determine the importance of an issue, event, development, or phenomenon for individuals or groups – identify biases in individual sources – determine if all points of view are represented in the source materials as a whole, and which, if any, are missing
Evaluate and Draw Conclusions
Students: – synthesize data, evidence, and information, and make informed, critical judgements based on that data, evidence, and information – determine the short- and long-term impact of an event, development, issue, or phenomenon on people and/or places – reach conclusions about the subject of their inquiry, and support them with their data, evidence, and information – make predictions based on their data, evidence, and information – determine the ethical implications of an issue or action – determine the action required, where appropriate
Communicate
Students: – use appropriate forms (e.g., oral, visual, written, multimedia) for different audiences and purposes – communicate their arguments, conclusions, predictions, and plans of action clearly and logically – use geographical terminology and concepts correctly and effectively – cite sources, using appropriate forms of documentation

World Issues: A Geographic Analysis, Grade 12

College Preparation

CGW4C

This course explores many difficult challenges facing Canada and the world today – challenges such as unequal access to food, water, and energy; urbanization; globalization; and meeting the needs of a growing world population while ensuring the sustainability of the natural environment. Students will explore these and other world issues from environmental, social, economic, and political perspectives, while applying the concepts of geographic thinking, the geographic inquiry process, and spatial technologies to guide and support their investigations.

Prerequisite: Issues in Canadian Geography, Grade 9, Academic or Applied

OVERVIEW

The course has five strands. Instruction and learning related to the expectations in strand A are to be interwoven with instruction and learning related to expectations from the other four strands. Strand A must not be seen as independent of the other strands. Student achievement of the expectations in strand A is to be assessed and evaluated *throughout* the course.

Strand A

A. Geographic Inquiry and Skill Development
Overall Expectations
A1. Geographic Inquiry: use the geographic inquiry process and the concepts of geographic thinking when investigating world issues
A2. Developing Transferable Skills: apply in everyday contexts skills, including spatial skills, developed through geographical investigation, and identify some careers in which a background in geography might be an asset

(continued)

Overview *(continued)*

Throughout this course, when planning instruction, teachers should weave the expectations from strand A in with the expectations from strands B–E.

Strands B–E

Overall Expectations and Related Concepts of Geographic Thinking	Big Ideas*	Framing Questions*
B. Spatial Organization: Regional Similarities and Differences		
B1. Economic Disparities: analyse interrelationships between social conditions, access to natural resources, government policies, and economic disparities within and between countries or regions (FOCUS ON: <i>Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective</i>)	Global inequalities are influenced by a wide variety of current and historical factors.	What are some impacts that may occur because of an inequitable distribution of resources? Why might some people believe that there is an ethical imperative to share the world's resources equitably?
B2. Resources and Human Systems: analyse global patterns of natural resource and population distribution and their interrelationship with human networks and systems (FOCUS ON: <i>Patterns and Trends; Interrelationships</i>)	The distribution and availability of natural and human resources can have significant impacts on the economy, population distribution, and infrastructure of a country.	What are some of the factors that influence the quality of life in different countries?
B3. Characteristics of World Regions: classify and compare countries and regions of the world, using appropriate criteria and statistical measures (FOCUS ON: <i>Spatial Significance; Patterns and Trends</i>)	Statistical indicators can help us understand spatial patterns of wealth and development around the world.	How do we measure the social and economic development of a region or a community? Are there potential biases in these measurements?
C. Sustainability and Stewardship		
C1. Environmental Stewardship: analyse the role of individuals, the local community, and governments in achieving sustainability, and assess opportunities for personal stewardship and involvement in sustainability initiatives (FOCUS ON: <i>Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective</i>)	Governments at all levels, companies, and individual citizens have a role to play in achieving sustainability.	Why do individuals, companies, and governments continue to make unsustainable choices? How might the environmental choices we make today have an impact on the world tomorrow?
C2. Resource Use and Sustainability: analyse selected resource uses and sustainability practices in a variety of countries (FOCUS ON: <i>Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective</i>)	The way that resources are extracted or harvested and the way they are used have a major influence on sustainability.	Why have some countries been more successful than others in extracting and using a natural resource in a sustainable way?
C3. Managing the Global Commons: explain the meaning and significance of the global commons, and analyse issues associated with the use and sustainability of its various elements (FOCUS ON: <i>Spatial Significance; Patterns and Trends</i>)	Resources that are essential for life are key components of the global commons.	What is the global commons? What can we do to protect the global commons?

* See page 17 for a discussion of the purpose of big ideas and framing questions.

Overall Expectations and Related Concepts of Geographic Thinking	Big Ideas*	Framing Questions*
D. Interactions and Interdependence: Globalization		
D1. Managing Globalization: assess responsibilities for managing the impacts of globalization, and describe ways in which impacts can be moderated (FOCUS ON: <i>Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective</i>)	Governments, businesses, and individuals need to work together to lessen the impacts of globalization.	Who benefits from globalization? Who loses? How is globalization affecting your life, your community, your country?
D2. Multinational Corporations: analyse issues related to the operations of multinational corporations in the global economy (FOCUS ON: <i>Spatial Significance; Geographic Perspective</i>)	Multinational companies can be a source of economic development, but their operations can also have widespread impacts that are difficult to manage.	How do our choices and beliefs contribute to globalization, and how are they influenced by globalization? How did we get to this level of globalization?
D3. Globalization – Characteristics and Impacts: analyse the principal characteristics and major impacts of globalization (FOCUS ON: <i>Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective</i>)	Globalization has major economic, environmental, social, and political impacts on countries around the world.	How does globalization affect the quality of life and quality of the environment in developing nations?
E. Changing Societies		
E1. Urbanization: analyse trends in urbanization in both economically developed and developing regions of the world, and assess the impacts of these trends (FOCUS ON: <i>Spatial Significance; Patterns and Trends</i>)	Urbanization has been occurring everywhere in the world and is having major impacts on people and the environment.	Are human rights issues more important than other global issues? Should we give higher priority to addressing them?
E2. Population Growth and Demographic Change: analyse global and regional population trends, and assess their impacts on society, the economy, and the ability of societies to meet basic human needs (FOCUS ON: <i>Patterns and Trends; Geographic Perspective</i>)	Global population growth and changing demographic profiles are creating social, economic, and environmental challenges in many countries.	How can demographic trends influence global food supply? Do we have a global population crisis?
E3. Human Rights and Quality of Life: analyse impacts of a variety of factors on human rights and quality of life in selected countries (FOCUS ON: <i>Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective</i>)	Human rights violations and quality of life issues continue to affect people in many countries.	Why is it important to be aware of and to address global inequalities of wealth and quality of life?

A. GEOGRAPHIC INQUIRY AND SKILL DEVELOPMENT

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1. Geographic Inquiry:** use the geographic inquiry process and the concepts of geographic thinking when investigating world issues;
- A2. Developing Transferable Skills:** apply in everyday contexts skills, including spatial skills, developed through geographical investigation, and identify some careers in which a background in geography might be an asset.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Geographic Inquiry

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1.1** formulate different types of questions to guide investigations into world issues (e.g., factual questions: *Which three countries in the world have the greatest fresh water resources?*; comparative questions: *Which map projection shows the relative size of land masses more accurately, a Mercator projection or a Peters projection?*; causal questions: *How does free trade facilitate the development of maquiladoras and similar systems of offshore production?*)
- A1.2** select and organize relevant data and information on geographic issues from a variety of primary and secondary sources (e.g., primary: *raw data from fieldwork, both quantitative and qualitative; photographs; satellite images*; secondary: *published statistics, newspapers, books, atlases, geographic magazines, websites, graphs, charts, digital and print maps*), ensuring that their sources represent a diverse range of perspectives
Sample questions: “How might you use quality of life indicators to analyse poverty distribution patterns in different parts of the world? Where might you find this data and information?” “What type of data and information do you need to collect in order to assess the impact of natural resource extraction or harvesting on a specific country and people?” “What types of maps and graphs will help you analyse immigration patterns?”

- A1.3** assess the credibility of sources and information relevant to their investigations (e.g., *by considering how the data are constructed to support the author’s point of view, the possible bias of the author, the expertise of the author, the accuracy of the text and supporting data, the intended audience, the purpose of the messaging, the context in which the information was presented*)

Sample questions: “Whose point of view does this source represent? Is the source biased? Have you consulted other sources that represent other points of view? Which source is most credible and why?”

- A1.4** interpret and analyse data and information relevant to their investigations, using various tools, strategies, and approaches appropriate for geographic inquiry (e.g., *interpret diagrams illustrating the flow of different food types from their source to the local grocery store; analyse graphs and charts of quality of life indicators for selected countries to determine trends and correlations; use decision-making templates to analyse points of view on an issue; use graphic organizers to outline various perspectives on natural resource use*)

Sample questions: “What type of graphic organizer would you use to help analyse the impact of offshore production on both the manufacturing country and the consumer country?” “What data layers and types of information might you include when using a geographic information system (GIS) to analyse the production of greenhouse gases globally?”

A1.5 use the concepts of geographic thinking (i.e., spatial significance, patterns and trends, interrelationships, geographic perspective) when analysing and evaluating data and information and formulating conclusions and/or judgements about world issues (*e.g., use the concept of spatial significance to analyse the distribution of desertification or poverty; use the concept of patterns and trends to analyse short- and long-term population trends and phenomena such as urbanization; use the concept of interrelationships to assess the influence of various natural and human factors on global inequalities; use the concept of geographic perspective to analyse the social, political, economic, and environmental impact of a significant technological change*)

Sample questions: “How might the concept of spatial significance help you define the characteristics of a ‘world-class’ city?” “How might an understanding of patterns and trends help you analyse the impact of the melting of continental ice?” “How might an understanding of interrelationships guide your investigation of the connections between a product you buy, the company that sells it, the resources used to make and dispose of it, and labour conditions in the factory that manufactures it?” “How can geographic perspective help you analyse the impacts of globalization on indigenous peoples around the world?”

A1.6 evaluate and synthesize their findings to formulate conclusions and/or make informed judgements or predictions about the issues they are investigating

Sample questions: “What did you find out about the relationship between foreign ownership and economic disparity in various regions of the world? How might this relationship continue to be an issue? What conclusions can you draw about why this relationship exists?”

A1.7 communicate their ideas, arguments, and conclusions using various formats and styles, as appropriate for the audience and purpose (*e.g., a debate for classmates on the use of water, a video for a Grade 8 class on how alternative energy is used in different parts of the world, a webcast or podcast for the general public on strategies for managing electronic waste, a blog for the school community about a current global issue, a photo essay for a local community group to illustrate the multicultural diversity within that community, a report for a consumers’ group on the environmental impacts of producing different types of food*)

Sample questions: “What kind of information does your audience need? In how much detail?” “What format and approach would be most effective in conveying your information to this particular audience?”

A1.8 use accepted forms of documentation (*e.g., footnotes, author/date citations, reference lists, bibliographies, annotated bibliographies, credits*) to reference different types of sources (*e.g., websites, blogs, books, articles, films, data*)

A1.9 use appropriate terminology when communicating the results of their investigations (*e.g., vocabulary specific to their inquiry; terminology related to geography and to the concepts of geographic thinking*)

A2. Developing Transferable Skills

Throughout this course, students will:

A2.1 describe ways in which geographic investigation can help them develop skills, including spatial skills and the essential skills in the Ontario Skills Passport (*e.g., reading graphic texts, writing, graphing, computer use, use of spatial technologies, oral communication, numeracy, decision making, planning, management, finding information, problem solving*), that can be transferred to postsecondary opportunities, the world of work, and everyday life

A2.2 apply in everyday contexts skills and work habits developed through geographic investigation (*e.g., ask questions to deepen their understanding of an issue; listen to and consider multiple perspectives when discussing an issue; collaborate with a team to determine the criteria that need to be considered when making a decision; use quantitative data to support an idea; use spatial skills to aid their understanding of world events*)

A2.3 apply the concepts of geographic thinking when analysing current events involving geographic issues (*e.g., use the concept of spatial significance to analyse possible reasons for the spread of a disease; use the concept of patterns and trends to analyse potential impacts of El Niño or La Niña on North and South America; use the concept of interrelationships to analyse the connection between high poverty levels and civil unrest in a particular country; use the concept of geographic perspective to analyse the potential consequences of a change in political leadership in a particular country*) in order to enhance their understanding of these issues and their role as informed citizens

A2.4 identify some careers in which a geography background might be an asset (*e.g., community service worker, import business owner, real estate agent, land surveyor, international aid worker, marketing analyst, town planner, GIS technician*)

B. SPATIAL ORGANIZATION: REGIONAL SIMILARITIES AND DIFFERENCES

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. Economic Disparities:** analyse interrelationships between social conditions, access to natural resources, government policies, and economic disparities within and between countries or regions (**FOCUS ON:** *Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective*)
- B2. Resources and Human Systems:** analyse global patterns of natural resource and population distribution and their interrelationship with human networks and systems (**FOCUS ON:** *Patterns and Trends; Interrelationships*)
- B3. Characteristics of World Regions:** classify and compare countries and regions of the world, using appropriate criteria and statistical measures (**FOCUS ON:** *Spatial Significance; Patterns and Trends*)

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. Economic Disparities

FOCUS ON: *Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** analyse the impact of a variety of economic, social, and political factors (*e.g., economic: availability of natural resources, level of economic development, foreign debt, dependence on foreign investment, technological change; social: level of education, access to health care, water and sewage infrastructure, openness to innovation and other cultural factors; political: stability of government, rule of law, degree to which government is representative of the population, colonial legacies*) on the unequal distribution of wealth within and between countries

Sample questions: “What is the relationship between gross domestic product and social indicators such as number of doctors per thousand people, availability of potable water, and average caloric intake per person?” “How is personal wealth distributed throughout the population of a selected country, and how does that compare with the way it is distributed in your community?” “What are some possible causes of economic disparity within your local community?” “How might socio-economic status affect a person’s access to water and food resources in different parts of the world?” “How is technological change affecting economic disparity in Canada?”

Using spatial skills: Students can use GIS to layer countries with respect to their ratings on the Human Development Index (HDI) and such indices as gross domestic product (GDP), caloric intake, and infant mortality. Using the map layers that have been generated, students can compare the relative importance of different factors in determining a country’s HDI and identify areas in which a country could benefit most from development assistance.

- B1.2** analyse environmental, economic, social, and political implications of the unequal distribution of natural, economic, and social resources, nationally and globally (*e.g., over-exploitation of scarce resources and destruction of ecosystems, disparities in standard of living, migration from resource-poor to resource-rich areas, conflict over access to and control over resources*)

Sample questions: “What are the possible consequences of the privatization of water supplies?” “How does an unequal distribution of food and water affect migration patterns? What is an environmental refugee?” “How does the use or abuse of a natural resource contribute to global economic disparities?” “What natural resources do you anticipate a high demand for in the near future, and what consequences might such a demand have?” “How might global inequities in resources lead to ethical dilemmas?”

B1.3 identify the effects of government policies and practices on economic and social disparities (e.g., *subsidies, tax incentives, supply management programs, and trade agreements may promote job creation and reduce disparities between individuals but may also increase some disparities by favouring some individuals, economic sectors, or regions over others; foreign aid programs provide resources to help economically poorer countries reduce disparities, but mismanagement of aid programs can also increase disparities within the receiving country*)

Sample questions: “Why do countries provide foreign aid to other countries?” “Should we reduce disparities in Canada before spending money to help people in other countries?” “How might a decision by a country’s political leaders to promote agricultural exports affect access to food within their country?” “Should university and college education be tuition-free in Canada, as it is in Cuba, Sweden, and most of Germany? Who would benefit? Who would pay for it?”

B1.4 describe the role and assess the impact of various intergovernmental agencies (e.g., *World Bank, International Monetary Fund*), government departments and agencies (e.g., *Department of Foreign Affairs, Trade and Development*), and non-governmental organizations (e.g., *micro-finance organizations such as the Grameen Bank; social enterprises such as Me to We; advocacy, aid, and development organizations or programs such as Because I Am a Girl*) that address inequities at local, national, and international levels

Sample questions: “How have different levels of government attempted to reduce inequities in Canada?” “How does Canada contribute to international efforts to alleviate financial stress in other countries?” “Do you think that countries receiving aid should pay it back in some way?” “Why do some people think that supporting social enterprise is a more effective way of helping people than donating to a charity?” “What criteria would you use to assess the effectiveness of an NGO’s efforts to reduce health care inequities?”

Using spatial skills: To support an investigation of transfer payments, students can construct a flow map illustrating the amount of money that Canada distributes annually in equalization payments to each of the provinces. They can then annotate the map with statistics such as provincial GDP, unemployment rate, and average income to indicate the economic strengths and weaknesses of each province. Students can construct a similar annotated flow map of the world, showing which countries receive Canadian foreign aid and indicating the economic characteristics and needs of the receiving countries.

B2. Resources and Human Systems

FOCUS ON: Patterns and Trends; Interrelationships

By the end of this course, students will:

B2.1 analyse maps to identify global distribution patterns for various natural resources and for human populations (e.g., *analyse a world night map to identify settlement patterns and the locations of large urban centres; analyse thematic maps to help identify the distribution of such features as fresh water resources, forests, and mineral deposits*), and assess the significance of these patterns

Sample questions: “What types of maps might you use to help you identify a relationship between the location of large urban centres and access to natural resources?” “Are there other countries in the world that have many of the same natural resources that Canada has?” “Why do large cities tend to be located on a coast or next to a lake or river?” “How might natural systems and characteristics account for similarities and differences between Canada and other countries in the world with respect to the distribution of resources and population?”

Using spatial skills: To identify correlations between water availability and agricultural output, students can layer maps of drainage basins or rainfall distribution with maps showing different types of agricultural activity, such as cattle grazing or fruit and vegetable growing.

B2.2 analyse the influence of various human infrastructure networks (e.g., *transportation networks, energy networks, communication networks*) on population settlement and access to resources

Sample questions: “What is the relationship between the distribution of population settlements and the location of food sources and food distribution systems?” “Where have irrigation systems made new settlements or larger settlements possible?” “What are the similarities and differences between Internet connections and transportation connections?” “What kinds of networks are involved in transferring different forms of energy between countries?” “Which countries in the world does Canada have direct ties to in terms of transportation links? Why do you think this is?” “What are some of the transportation issues that face Canadian, Russian, Scandinavian, and other communities north of the 60th parallel?” “How are network-based relationships both a source of support for a country and a source of vulnerability?” “Why might a settlement be located in an area where the resources needed to support

its people are not readily available? What kind of infrastructure would be needed to sustain it?"

Using spatial skills: In order to visualize how resources flow from sources to consumers, students can add map layers showing the location of various resources such as water, food, oil, and gas and the location of networks such as electricity grids, pipelines, different types of surface transportation, and Internet connections to a base map of population settlements. The maps can be used to support an analysis of the factors influencing the pattern of these networks.

- B2.3** analyse the relationship between a country's wealth and its economic structure (*e.g., economic structures based on resource extraction or harvesting versus structures with a higher proportion of resource processing, manufacturing, and tertiary industry*)

Sample questions: "Why do countries whose economies are heavily dependent on resource extraction tend to be poorer? Are there exceptions? Why?" "Should Canada process more of its natural resources, such as oil and forest products, at home, instead of shipping unprocessed resources to other countries? What would the advantages be? What are the obstacles to doing so?"

Using spatial skills: Flow maps and various graphs can be used to help students visualize import and export data and classify the types of commodities and products being exchanged between various countries. To analyse relationships between gross domestic product and the structure of national economies, students can construct a thematic map showing the countries with the ten highest GDPs and the ten lowest, using circle graphs to represent the percentage of the workforce in each country employed in primary, secondary, and tertiary industries.

B3. Characteristics of World Regions

FOCUS ON: *Spatial Significance; Patterns and Trends*

By the end of this course, students will:

- B3.1** compare the quality of life in different regions of the world, using appropriate statistical data and indicators (*e.g., literacy rate, gross domestic product, access to medical care, access to clean water, infant mortality rate, fertility rate, school enrolment rate, employment by economic sector*)

Sample questions: "What projection or cartogram could you use to analyse and represent this data? How might this help you determine spatial patterns that reflect differences in quality of life and identify possible causes for these differences?" "What values and beliefs are

implicit in these indicators, and why might these values be similar or different in various parts of the world?"

Using spatial skills: Students can use a GIS program to create cartograms that can be used to interpret and compare quality of life indicators for different regions of the world.

- B3.2** identify a variety of terms used to classify countries on the basis of similar economic, social, political, regional, or other characteristics (*e.g., informal classifications, such as North/South, developed/underdeveloped, First World/Third World, advanced, BRIC, emerging economies, free world, sub-Saharan, Middle Eastern; formal groupings, such as the European Union, African Union, Organization of American States, la Francophonie, Association of Southeast Asian Nations, Alliance of Small Island States*), and assess the usefulness of these terms

Sample questions: "What is the value of grouping countries in this way? How do these groupings help our understanding of these countries? What are the dangers of grouping countries in this way? Is there also a risk that this could lead to misunderstandings and the perpetuation of stereotypes?" "What values do various groupings represent? How useful are these groupings if the characteristics of some of the countries change?" "In what circumstances would it be helpful to organize countries according to the availability of their natural resources?" "Countries can belong to a variety of formal groups that they join voluntarily in order to pursue common interests or deal with common concerns. What are some of these organizations, and what are the interests and concerns that they deal with? What advantages does a country gain by belonging to such organizations?" "Are there any peoples excluded from such groupings, such as peoples without a state? How else might they organize themselves globally?"

Using spatial skills: Students can use a Peters projection and a Mercator projection to see how different map projections distort country size and shape. Students can then consider whether maps may convey a bias and why one map might be chosen over another to support a particular message related to classification.

- B3.3** analyse statistical data (*e.g., GDP per capita, literacy rate, mortality rate, employment in agriculture, temperature and rainfall, natural resource production*) to identify and explain correlations between population characteristics and a variety of environmental, economic, social, and political factors

Sample questions: "What pattern do you see when you look at access to clean water and levels of infant mortality? Why is there a connection

between them? Are there any countries or regions that do not fit this pattern?" "What pattern emerges when you plot data for average daily caloric intake and the death rate for countries around the world? What other factors might contribute to this pattern?" "How does the Canadian distribution of natural characteristics (e.g., water, mineral, and flow resources) and human characteristics (e.g., food production, GDP, education) compare to that in other regions of the world?"

Using spatial skills: On a scatter plot, students can determine the strength of a correlation between two variables, such as availability of potable water and death rate, by drawing a line of best fit between them. A close fit between the line and the plotted points indicates a strong correlation. A looser fit indicates a weaker correlation.

C. SUSTAINABILITY AND STEWARDSHIP

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Environmental Stewardship:** analyse the role of individuals, the local community, and governments in achieving sustainability, and assess opportunities for personal stewardship and involvement in sustainability initiatives (**FOCUS ON:** *Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective*)
- C2. Resource Use and Sustainability:** analyse selected resource uses and sustainability practices in a variety of countries (**FOCUS ON:** *Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective*)
- C3. Managing the Global Commons:** explain the meaning and significance of the global commons, and analyse issues associated with the use and sustainability of its various elements (**FOCUS ON:** *Spatial Significance; Patterns and Trends*)

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Environmental Stewardship

FOCUS ON: *Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** identify opportunities for personal stewardship and involvement in sustainability initiatives at a local, national, and international level (*e.g., buying locally, participating in community gardens, conserving water, carpooling and ride sharing, walking or riding instead of driving, supporting organizations that promote sustainability*), and assess the environmental, economic, social, and political implications of their choices

Sample questions: “What can you, as an individual, do to reduce water use, energy consumption, air pollution, and waste? What environmental and economic effects would these actions have?” “What effects might your decision to buy locally produced and manufactured goods have on you and your local community? How might that decision affect people in other countries that also produce or manufacture that product? Is buying locally always the most sustainable option?”

Using spatial skills: Students can encourage eating locally by using GIS to identify where different types of food are produced near their community and creating an infographic to display in the school halls. They can also use GIS water data showing their community’s connection with larger drainage basins to investigate the impact of their own water usage on the environment in the wider region.

- C1.2** explain the role of governments and the local community in promoting and achieving sustainability, and identify ways in which individuals can encourage sustainability initiatives by governments and organizations in the community

Sample questions: “Why do governments have a crucial role to play in achieving sustainability? What are our governments doing to protect air and water quality and to manage climate change? How do we influence governments to follow policies that promote sustainability?” “How can conservation and the use of alternative energies contribute to sustainability? How can governments encourage these strategies at the local level?” “What are some of the political obstacles that governments might face in trying to implement sustainability policies?” “What can community groups and businesses do to promote sustainability?”

Using spatial skills: To support their investigations of the role of governments in promoting sustainability, students can produce a map showing the ten countries with the highest level of installed solar capacity. The map can be annotated to show, for each country, the average hours of bright sunshine per year and the availability of government supports or subsidies for solar power.

C2. Resource Use and Sustainability

FOCUS ON: *Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

C2.1 analyse environmental, economic, social, and political impacts related to the use of selected natural resources at the local, national, and global level (*e.g., impacts of freshwater consumption, different methods of energy production*)

Sample questions: “How does the location of a resource affect how it is extracted, harvested, processed, or used?” “What percentage of the world’s oil and gas resources does Canada have? How does this compare to other countries? What are the economic benefits for Canada of developing these resources? How does their development affect Canada’s ecological footprint?” “What are the difficulties in measuring the social and environmental impacts of pipelines used to transport oil and gas?” “How might a country’s level of poverty influence practices for extracting and processing natural resources in that country?” “What ethical dilemmas do countries face when making decisions about the development of resources that have high economic value but involve large environmental or social costs (*e.g., coal in China, tantalum or coltan in Brazil and the Democratic Republic of Congo, diamonds in various African countries*)?” “How does Canada’s per capita consumption of fresh water compare to that of other countries? What regions in Canada have an abundant supply of fresh water? Should these regions share their water resources with the rest of the country and the world?”

C2.2 analyse and compare various sustainability initiatives and practices for energy production in different regions of the world (*e.g., global initiatives, such as the United Nations Sustainable Energy for All program; regional initiatives, such as the European Union’s biofuels directive; national and provincial initiatives, such as Australia’s solar credits program and Ontario’s microFIT program for renewable energy*)

Sample questions: “Why have certain countries become global leaders in alternative energy, and what methods are they using for electricity production?” “What initiatives and practices can be implemented at a local level to facilitate the adoption of alternative energy sources?” “How do the costs and benefits associated with small-scale energy production compare with those of large-scale energy production?” “How does Ontario’s Green Energy Act support the development of sustainable energy projects?”

“How do sustainable development initiatives in Finland also work to reduce poverty?”

Using spatial skills: Using GIS, students can add a map layer of wind farm data to a base map of Ontario communities to locate various sites across the province where electricity from wind is generated. Using World Bank fossil fuel consumption data and GDP statistics, students may also identify countries that do not have easy access to fossil fuels. Students can then investigate the alternative sources that those countries are using to meet their energy needs.

C2.3 describe criteria and strategies that consumers can use to determine whether resources used in the goods they consume have been extracted, processed, and produced sustainably

Sample questions: “What criteria must a product meet in order to be labelled fair trade? How might these criteria influence your purchases?” “How can you determine whether the clothing or electronics you purchase have been ethically and/or sustainably produced?”

C3. Managing the Global Commons

FOCUS ON: *Spatial Significance; Patterns and Trends*

By the end of this course, students will:

C3.1 identify the components of the global commons (*e.g., oceans, air, outer space*), and explain their environmental, economic, social, and political importance (*e.g., oceans and atmosphere support life, control climate, facilitate communications; oceans contain exploitable resources; space facilitates communications, navigation, and observation of the earth*)

Sample questions: “What are the global commons? Why are they global? Why are they common?” “Is Antarctica considered part of the global commons?” “Why might some people argue that cyberspace is a component of the global commons?” “What are some of the ways in which we use the various components of the global commons?” “If an iceberg is outside a country’s territorial waters, does anybody own it? Would anybody have the right to tow it to a country where water is scarce and sell it for its freshwater content?”

C3.2 analyse issues related to human impacts on the global commons (*e.g., threats to ocean life as a result of increased shipping, overfishing, and acidification; increased air pollution and climate change as a result of industrial activity*) and to international management of the commons (*e.g., lack of international authority to regulate*

the use of the global commons; difficulty of getting countries to subordinate national interests to the welfare of the planet)

Sample questions: “How are human activities changing the atmosphere and the oceans? What impact have these changes had on the Arctic and on Canadian control over our Arctic waters?” “If people were injured by debris from a rocket or satellite falling from space, who would be responsible?” “How does your ecological footprint affect the global commons? How does it compare to that of Canada as a whole and to that of other countries in the world?” “What is meant by the ‘tragedy of the commons’?” “How do we manage something that everybody uses but nobody owns? What are some of the ways in which we currently attempt to manage the global commons?”

Using spatial skills: To support their investigations of geopolitical issues related to the use of Arctic waters and the exploitation of Arctic resources, students can use a polar projection of the region in order to visualize the convergence of political boundaries towards the pole.

D. INTERACTIONS AND INTERDEPENDENCE: GLOBALIZATION

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Managing Globalization:** assess responsibilities for managing the impacts of globalization, and describe ways in which these impacts can be moderated (**FOCUS ON:** *Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective*)
- D2. Multinational Corporations:** analyse issues related to the operations of multinational corporations in the global economy (**FOCUS ON:** *Spatial Significance; Geographic Perspective*)
- D3. Globalization – Characteristics and Impacts:** analyse the principal characteristics and major impacts of globalization (**FOCUS ON:** *Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective*)

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Managing Globalization

FOCUS ON: *Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1.1** describe the characteristics of global citizenship, and explain how individuals, acting as global citizens, can help to lessen economic, social, and environmental impacts associated with globalization (*e.g., by informing themselves about how products are made and disposed of, buying fair-trade products, boycotting products made through exploitive practices, raising awareness of labour and environmental issues in developing countries, supporting NGOs that are active in promoting workers' rights and environmental protection in producing countries*)

Sample questions: “In what ways are we members of a global community, and what responsibilities do we have to that community?” “Should consumers be concerned about how the products they buy are made? Would you be willing to pay more for products that have not been produced in sweatshops?” “How can you find out where products are made and whether manufacturers follow acceptable labour and environmental practices?” “What are some examples of fair-trade products, and how does fair-trade certification protect small producers in developing countries?” “How can you

influence labour standards in other countries through your purchases? How can you support Canadian businesses through your purchases?”

- D1.2** assess the responsibilities of governments and businesses for managing economic, environmental, and social impacts associated with globalization, and describe ways in which this could be done (*e.g., through national laws regarding foreign operations of domestic companies, international organizations such as the International Labour Organization, international agreements such as the Basel Convention, voluntary business initiatives such as implementing codes of conduct requiring foreign suppliers to meet more stringent labour and environmental standards, making information available to consumers about where their products are made and what standards their suppliers must adhere to*)

Sample questions: “In what ways do various governments ensure that businesses based in their countries operate ethically and legally in other countries? Why might some countries choose not to ensure this?” “What is the Basel Convention? What is the Accord on Fire and Building Safety in Bangladesh?” “What responsibility do businesses have to ensure that they do not exploit workers or cause environmental damage in the countries in which they operate?” “What can governments and businesses in developed countries do to offset the impacts of globalization on their economies?”

D2. Multinational Corporations

FOCUS ON: *Spatial Significance; Geographic Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

D2.1 analyse the characteristics of multinational corporations (*e.g., assets and revenues of selected companies, number of countries in which a company operates, goods and services offered, number of employees, percentage of employees in a company's home country, type of foreign operation*) and trends relating to these corporations' role in the international economy (*e.g., changes in the number of multinational companies and their home countries, expansion into new countries and economic sectors*)

Sample questions: "How many companies can you identify that have annual revenues greater than the GDP of Pakistan?" "What sectors of the economy are multinational firms involved in?" "Is the number of multinational companies increasing?" "Are multinational companies based only in developed countries?" "Large companies often set up foreign operations or outsource production to cut costs. What are some other reasons why a company would benefit from operating in another country?" "What are some of the different ways in which a multinational company can operate within a country?"

Using spatial skills: To support their investigations of multinational corporations, students can develop profiles of selected companies, using a world map as a base layer to show where their operations are located and summarizing details such as products manufactured or services provided, annual revenues, numbers employed, and wages and working conditions of employees. Students can then combine their findings to construct a class-generated annotated map.

D2.2 analyse labour, environmental, social, and other issues related to the operation of multinational companies in selected sectors (*e.g., mining, manufacturing, agriculture*) and countries

Sample questions: "How do working conditions and wages in the operations of multinational companies in the sector you are investigating compare with those of locally owned companies?" "If a large international retailer outsources the production of garments to a foreign manufacturer, what responsibility does it have for the wages and working conditions of the manufacturer's employees?" "To what extent do weak labour regulations in a manufacturing country make it possible to use child labour?" "What

impacts have mining operations of Canadian-owned corporations had on indigenous peoples in Latin America? How have these operations affected the environment? What have the political consequences been?" "Have weak environmental regulations influenced the locations of multinational operations in the sector you are investigating?" "Why might the government of a country want a foreign company to operate in that country? What incentives do multinationals have to be good corporate citizens in the countries in which they operate? How can they benefit the countries in which they operate? How might they be limited in their ability to influence labour conditions and environmental practices in those countries?"

D3. Globalization – Characteristics and Impacts

FOCUS ON: *Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

D3.1 describe patterns and trends associated with globalization (*e.g., increased movement of people between countries, increased communication and exchange of ideas between countries, increased integration of national economies with each other, transnational production of goods*), and analyse their causes (*e.g., liberalization of trade, availability of cheap labour in developing countries, consumerism in developed countries*)

Sample questions: "It is often said that the world is getting smaller. In what ways?" "How many countries are involved in making a typical tablet computer? Why isn't all the work done in just one country?" "How many products that you use every day are made in Canada? What criteria have to be met before a product can be labelled 'Made in Canada'?" "Why is a major economic crisis in a large consuming and producing country like the United States or China a global concern?" "How does a reduction in trade barriers make globalization possible?" "How does the demand for cheap consumer goods in developed countries and the availability of cheap labour in developing countries encourage globalization?" "What role has technology played in globalization?"

Using spatial skills: Using a world map as a base, students can show increases in global interaction by adding data layers for a variety of global connections at different points in time. Possible data sets include international flight destinations for a particular airport, Internet traffic, and countries associated with particular trade agreements or relationships. The data can also be graphed in various ways to show the rate and magnitude of the changes.

D3.2 analyse impacts of globalization on human and natural systems within various countries (e.g., *increased industrial employment in developing countries, but with low wages and poor working conditions; disruption of traditional societies and economies; loss of manufacturing capacity and manufacturing jobs in developed countries; increased water and air pollution in developing countries; increased greenhouse gas emissions from transportation; damage to local ecosystems from invasive species introduced by global travel and trade*)

Sample questions: “How is globalization affecting indigenous communities in various parts of the world?” “How might a consumer-driven economy that depends on cheap, easily disposable goods (sometimes called a ‘disposable economy’) contribute to disparities at both a local and a global level?” “In what ways does globalization facilitate the spread of disease between countries? Why might some countries

be more vulnerable to the spread of disease than others?” “In what ways has globalization facilitated human and animal trafficking?” “How has globalization affected national security?” “In what ways has the world benefited from globalization?” “What is the difference between the impacts of globalization on developed countries and its impacts on developing countries?” “Has globalization encouraged the mixing of cultures, or has it reinforced Western cultural domination?” “Does tourism give people a better appreciation of other cultures? How do large international events like the Olympic Games affect our awareness of other countries and our interactions with them?” “How has globalization contributed to greater consumption and resource use? How has it affected the flow and disposal of e-waste and other toxic wastes associated with these uses?”

E. CHANGING SOCIETIES

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- E1. Urbanization:** analyse trends in urbanization in both economically developed and developing regions of the world, and assess the impacts of these trends (**FOCUS ON:** *Spatial Significance; Patterns and Trends*)
- E2. Population Growth and Demographic Change:** analyse global and regional population trends, and assess their impacts on society, the economy, and the ability of societies to meet basic human needs (**FOCUS ON:** *Patterns and Trends; Geographic Perspective*)
- E3. Human Rights and Quality of Life:** analyse impacts of a variety of factors on human rights and quality of life in selected countries (**FOCUS ON:** *Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective*)

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

E1. Urbanization

FOCUS ON: *Spatial Significance; Patterns and Trends*

By the end of this course, students will:

- E1.1** analyse trends in urban growth, locally and globally, and explain factors contributing to these trends (*e.g., displacement of small farms by larger industrialized farming operations, settlement of refugees in or near larger urban settlements, rural overpopulation, economic opportunities in cities*)

Sample questions: “Where are the most populated regions of the world? Why do so many people live in these areas? What proportion of the population lives in cities in these areas? What proportion lived in cities fifty years ago?” “Why are people leaving rural environments? What attracts them to cities?”

Using spatial skills: Students can use a world night map layered with a political map to construct a thematic population map showing the megalopolis regions of the world. Students can also use statistics related to size of population and population density to create graphs showing trends in urban growth for selected urban regions in different parts of the world.

- E1.2** analyse the role of migrant neighbourhoods in the settlement of new arrivals to a city, and assess, from a geographic perspective, the impacts of this type of settlement on the residents of these communities and on the larger urban area that they are a part of (*e.g., improved quality of life for migrants, access to economic opportunities,*

increased demands on the social resources of the host communities, health and environmental impacts related to lack of clean water and waste disposal infrastructure in informal settlements)

Sample questions: “Do Aboriginal people moving to cities in Canada concentrate in particular neighbourhoods? Why or why not? Why might it be different for cities like Winnipeg or Vancouver compared to Toronto or Calgary?” “Why do new immigrants often choose to move to neighbourhoods where other immigrants have already settled? How have local governments responded to new immigrant settlements in different parts of the world?” “How might the establishment of informal settlements or the concentration of a large new immigrant population in an existing neighbourhood affect the economy of a city? What characteristics do these settlements and neighbourhoods have that continue to attract individuals?” “Migrant settlements and neighbourhoods have been called ‘arrival cities’. What are some of the different kinds of arrival cities that can be found in various parts of the world, and what are the living conditions associated with them?”

Using spatial skills: Students can use census data for selected urban settlements to identify areas where recent immigrants have settled. Annotations can be added to maps of the settlements to provide more detailed information about the immigrant populations, such as their countries of origin and mother tongues.

- E1.3** assess the impacts of increased urbanization on the environment and society (*e.g., land*

degradation, loss of agricultural land, increased demand on services and infrastructure, social tensions, greater economic opportunities)

Sample questions: “What are the environmental and economic impacts of using arable land for housing?” “What are some social issues that might arise in a community with a very high population density?” “What are some of the social, economic, and political consequences of having an urban population that is aging?” “What are some of the forms that transitory housing can take in cities (e.g., squats, tent cities, shantytowns)?” “How does urbanization contribute to homelessness?” “What are some challenges relating to water and sanitation management that a local government might face as a result of population increases?” “How might increasing urbanization affect the production and distribution of food?”

E2. Population Growth and Demographic Change

FOCUS ON: *Patterns and Trends; Geographic Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

E2.1 analyse trends in global and regional population growth (e.g., *continuing global population growth, rapid population growth in underdeveloped countries, negative population growth and aging population in some developed countries*) and their causes, and assess their social and economic impacts

Sample questions: “What is the world’s population now? What is it expected to be in 2050?” “In what regions of the world is the population growing fastest? Which regions are showing the slowest population growth? Do any countries have shrinking populations?” “How do you explain these trends? For example, how does a better standard of living affect the rate of population growth? What effect does improvement in women’s rights have on population growth?” “How will additional population growth affect the environment?” “Which countries have the youngest populations? Which ones have the oldest populations? What are the economic and social advantages of a young population? What are the potential problems and challenges? What challenges does a society face as its population ages?” “How does immigration help countries with older populations deal with economic problems related to aging? What are the effects on the countries that younger people are leaving?”

E2.2 analyse the impact of population growth and rising standards of living on the world’s food

supply and its characteristics, and assess options for meeting future global food requirements (e.g., *increasing productivity through high-yield crop varieties, genetically modified crops, intensive farming, industrial farming, aquaculture; increasing amount of land under cultivation through irrigation, forest clearance, and other means; making greater use of existing resources by reducing the amount of animal protein in our diets*)

Sample questions: “How has the world’s output of staple foods such as wheat and rice changed over the past half-century?” “What was the ‘Green Revolution’? Can the same approach expand food production enough to feed the world’s population in 2050?” “How do practices such as industrial agriculture, intensive farming, and aquaculture increase food production? What impacts might they have on the environment, human health, and animal welfare?” “What environmental challenges make it difficult for indigenous peoples to restore or maintain traditional diets?” “Can you identify some areas of the world where irrigation would provide a major increase in food output? What are the potential environmental dangers?” “How has forest clearance in the Amazon affected food production in Brazil? How does forest clearance contribute to climate change? How do you think Brazil should manage this problem?” “How might agricultural productivity in tropical countries be affected by climate change over the next century?” “What changes in your personal habits and choices might you consider to support food sustainability?” “Why are large corporations and countries such as China, Saudi Arabia, and Japan buying large amounts of farmland in Africa?” “How is the family farm changing in North America? Can small-scale farms in developing countries be part of the solution to the problem of feeding more people?” “How might improvements in food distribution systems prevent local and regional food shortages?”

E3. Human Rights and Quality of Life

FOCUS ON: *Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

E3.1 analyse interrelationships between demographic characteristics, economic development, and quality of life for selected countries (e.g., *interrelationships between fertility rate, GDP per capita, and lack of education for girls; interrelationships between ownership of land and resources and possession of wealth and power*)

Sample questions: “How are economic underdevelopment, quality of life, and birth rates

interrelated? Why do countries with lower birth rates tend to have higher standards of living?" "How has resource development affected the quality of life of indigenous peoples in various parts of the world?" "What data would you use to investigate the reasons behind the use of children in small-scale mines?" "If quality of life indicators were applied specifically to indigenous populations in selected countries, how might those results compare with results for the non-indigenous populations in the same countries? With results from other countries?"

Using spatial skills: Students can use World Bank statistics for the number of children (aged 7–14) employed in manufacturing in various countries to create a map layer showing the spatial distribution of child labour in the world. Students could also add a map layer of quality of life indicators to identify correlations between the prevalence of child labour and the quality of life in selected countries.

- E3.2** analyse national and international responses to human rights violations in various parts of the world (*e.g., policies and programs aimed at eliminating child labour, stopping the use of child soldiers, promoting the education of girls, preventing human trafficking*)

Sample questions: "How do programs such as Because I Am a Girl, the Roméo Dallaire Child Soldiers Initiative, and Stop the Traffik attempt to limit human rights abuses? How successful have they been?" "Why was the Ottawa Treaty to ban the use of antipersonnel landmines brought into being? What does it require states to do? Why have some states refused to sign it?" "Why don't all victims of human rights violations experience the same global support?" "How successful has the National League for Democracy been in restoring democratic rights in Myanmar?"

- E3.3** identify factors that contribute to poverty, and assess various programs and approaches for alleviating poverty, locally, nationally, and internationally (*e.g., government policies and programs such as minimum-wage laws, income-based housing, relief programs, and debt forgiveness; aid programs of intergovernmental organizations such as the United Nations and the World Bank; activities of non-governmental relief and development organizations such as Oxfam, the Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation, and local food banks*)

Sample questions: "What is meant by 'the cycle of poverty'? Why is it so difficult to break this cycle? Do Canadians have a social responsibility

to help break the cycle of poverty?" "What are some of the factors that contribute to poverty in Canada? Why is there a higher rate of poverty among single-parent families?" "What factors contribute to poverty in developing countries? Can the same solutions that we use to alleviate poverty at the local level in Canada also be applied in other countries?" "How do approaches such as microfinance and fair trade help to alleviate poverty in developing countries?"

- E3.4** describe various ways in which the Canadian government provides security for people in Canada and in other countries (*e.g., border security, search and rescue, disaster relief, consular support of Canadians abroad, peacekeeping and other international military operations, intelligence collection, participation in collective security organizations*), and analyse issues related to national security

Sample questions: "What responsibility does the Department of Foreign Affairs, Trade and Development have for assisting Canadians who run into difficulty abroad, and what kinds of challenges does it face in providing this protection?" "How does Canada's participation in peacekeeping missions protect the quality of life of people living in conflict zones?" "What is collective security, and how does it contribute to the security of Canada and Canadians?" "Should the needs of national security take precedence over individual rights? Is it justifiable to violate the human rights of some individuals in order to protect the human rights of others?"

Using spatial skills: To support their analysis of the role of Canadian military forces in supporting national and international security, students can annotate a world map to show where Canadian forces are currently operating and describe the purpose and nature of operations in each of the areas indicated.